

Middle East

This part of the world is hot and dry, with large deserts. Three of the world's great religions began here.



Mecca

The holiest place for a Muslim is the Ka'ba, a cube-shaped shrine in Mecca. Muslims face the Ka'ba when they pray and try to visit it at least once in their lifetime.

World's first skyscrapers

The people of Yemen started building mud-brick skyscrapers thousands of years ago. The ground floors are used for animals or for storing goods. Families live in the upper floors.



Fruits of the desert

Farmers can grow crops only in the wettest parts of the Middle East.



Figs are soft, sticky fruits that can be dried to make them last longer.



Olive trees are grown for their fruit, which is pressed to make olive oil.



Dates are the fruit of palm trees, which grow by rivers and in oases.

Mediterranean Sea

Istanbul

Blue Mosque

ANKARA

Turkey

NICOSIA

Cyprus

Sculpted menorah in Jerusalem